



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

vedapādo yūpadaṃṣṭraḥ kratudantaś citīmukhaḥ | BRP213.033.1
agnijihvo darbharomā brahmaśīrṣo mahātapāḥ || 33 || BRP213.033.2
ahorātrekṣaṇo divyo vedāṅgaḥ śrutibhūṣaṇaḥ | BRP213.034.1
ājyanāsaḥ sruvatunḍaḥ sāmaghoṣasvaro mahān || 34 || BRP213.034.2
satyadharmamayaḥ śrīmān kramavikramasatkṛtaḥ | BRP213.035.1
prāyaścittanakho ghoraḥ paśujānur mukhākṛtiḥ || 35 || BRP213.035.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 213: Manifestations of Viṣṇu (Chapter 213), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Brahmapurāṇa beautifully paint a symbolic picture of Viṣṇu, not as a literal form, but as the very embodiment of cosmic order and sacrifice. Think of it: Viṣṇu's feet are the Vedas, His tusk the sacrificial post, His teeth the sacrifices themselves, and His mouth the altar. This isn't about physical features, but about understanding that everything sacred, everything upholding dharma, emanates from and is intrinsically linked to the divine.

The fire is His tongue, the sacred grass His hair, and Brahman Himself is His head. He is described as possessing intense spiritual power, highlighting the austerity and dedication required to understand and embody these principles. His eyes are day and night, representing his constant awareness and unwavering presence throughout all of time. The limbs of the Vedas are His form, and the sacred scriptures adorn Him, emphasizing the importance of knowledge and the upholding of Vedic principles.

The clarified butter is His nose, the ladle His beak, and the sounds of the Sāma Veda, a sacred chant, are His glorious voice. This paints a picture of sacrifice and offering, where Viṣṇu accepts all that is given with devotion. He is made of truth and dharma, glorious and honored by steady progress and righteous actions. His nails are expiations, representing the power to cleanse and purify. He has a frightening aspect, yet His face is shaped like a sacrificial animal, again drawing you back to the theme of sacrifice and surrender.

How does this apply to your life today? It's an invitation to see the sacred in the mundane. Every action, when performed with intention and devotion, becomes a sacrifice. Your work, your relationships, your thoughts – all can be offerings at the altar of life. Strive to embody truth and dharma in your daily life, understanding that even small acts of kindness and integrity contribute to the cosmic order. The path to spiritual understanding lies not just in ritual, but in living a life dedicated to righteousness and selfless service.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small act of "sacrifice" can you offer today to align yourself more closely with truth and dharma?